

FINAL COUNTDOWN (Far left) Mahayuti leaders at a 'Ladki Bahin' welfare scheme launch in Aug.; MVA leaders greet the crowd at a party meet in Mumbai

Photographs by ANI

A BATTLE IVAL

MAHARASHTRA IS THE BIG PRIZE. WITH SIX PARTIES, TWO MAJOR ALLIANCES, IT IS LOOKING AT A NEVER-BEFORE ASSEMBLY POLL THAT MAY SEND TWO REGIONAL FORMATIONS INTO OBLIVION, CROWN TWO OTHER KINGS AND HAVE NATIONAL POLITICAL REPERCUSSIONS

By DHAVAL S. KULKARNI